

death. By now an unexpected change had taken place in Stravinsky's style. Previously hostile to the music of Schoenberg and Webern, he now found himself increasingly stimulated by the possibilities opened up by the different kinds of "serial" or 12-note methods that these composers had evolved. The result was a sequence of late, tersely concentrated works filtering his own musical techniques through this new one. They include the ballet *Agon*, the ultra-compressed piano concerto *Movements*, and the choral and orchestral *Requiem Canticles*, which was played at the funeral service before Stravinsky's burial in the Russian Orthodox cemetery in Venice. The continuing popularity of Stravinsky's great early ballet scores has tended to deflect from wider appreciation of later masterpieces like these. No other 20th-century composer's music covered more ground with such ceaseless brilliance and inventiveness.



STRAVINSKY AT THE PIANO, 1934